

3.6 Constitution of India and Equality

A Constitution is a set of rules and regulations guiding the administration of a country. Article 14 of the constitution of India provides equality before the law or equal protection within the territory of India and prohibits the unreasonable discrimination between persons.

Our Constitution says ours is a land of diversity; therefore, equality has to be ensured for all. Two significant parameters to ensure equality in society are respecting diversity and ensuring freedom. The different kinds of freedom are freedom to follow their religion, speak their language, celebrate their festivals and express their views freely.

The Constitution is a legal framework of rules and regulations by which a nation would function. Equality is where untouchability is seen as a crime. In India, as per the Article 17 of the Indian Constitution, untouchability is totally abolished and it's any form is forbidden.

Even today, different types of discrimination are reported across the country. Women, peasants, tribes and people from lower social classes are still striving for equality in India.

Summary

- Prejudice means to judge other people in a negative or inferior manner, without knowing much about them.
- Stereotype is a false view or idea about something.
- Discrimination can be defined as negative actions towards people. Discrimination can happen on the basis of colour, class, religion and gender.
- Caste system is the most dominant reason for inequality and discrimination.
- Gender discrimination refers to health, education, economic and political inequalities between men and women.
- Religious discrimination is unequal treatment of an individual or group based on their beliefs.

GLOSSARY

1.	Prejudice	-	Negatively judging other people or seeing other people as inferior
2.	Stereotype	-	Creating a standard image
3.	Discrimination	-	When people are not treated equally on the basis of caste, colour, religion, sex etc.,
4.	Inequality	-	Lacking equality, either economic or social or both
5.	Constitution	-	A constitution is a set of fundamental principles or established precedents according to which a state or other organisation is governed.